

Small Moves, Strong Finish — Teacher Guide

Morning Spark at 7:15. Ember at 2:05. Four grade bands, Monday to Thursday. No school Friday, October 9.

Run the matched week

Theme: Small Moves, Strong Finish. Morning Spark gives students a low-demand entry task and a reason to notice, infer, and choose. Ember asks students to name what they actually did and its effect.

7:15: greet by name at the door; point to the Do Now. Students answer independently in 3-5 minutes. K-2 read a book afterward; grades 3-8 move to the displayed IXL Math/Reading codes. In the 2-3 deck, grade 2 reads and grade 3 uses IXL.

Announcements are the hard stop, about 7:37. After announcements, run a reveal for no more than two minutes. Give 10 seconds to think; invite one or two responses. On Monday, keep feelings private and invite volunteers only. At 7:45, hand off to Morning Meeting.

Ember: open the board and place a reflection slip before 2:05. Keep the original flow: 2:05 seated pack-up, 2:08 calm-down video or breathing fallback, 2:13 written/drawn reflection, then seated waiting. Release only on the adult announcement. Retain the existing route order and numbered Chromebook cart return.

The existing Ember board shows walkers at 2:10, car riders/aftercare and activities at 2:15, then buses K-2 at 2:17, 3-5 at 2:20, and 6-8 at 2:23. These inherited times remain subject to the campus dismissal plan; the clock display never authorizes students to leave.

Use the classroom decks Monday through Thursday, October 5-8. Thursday's reflection gives students a chance to name a finish and a habit they will carry forward.

Daily delivery and reveal

Monday - Check-In (start ready): Distribute a folded private slip. Each band checks in differently, then picks one small move to start ready. K-1: circle a weather-inside face (sunny, cloudy, rainy, stormy, windy, foggy, rainbow) or the talk-to-a-grown-up child. 2-3: circle a weather and one ready move (breaths, materials, read the board, ask a question). 4-5: energy battery 1-5, one small move, optional adult check-in box. 6-8: ready level 1-5, a word or two, and one move within their control. Reveal teaches a new regulation move for each band: K-1 flower-and-candle breaths; 2-3 five-finger breathing (the dot traces the hand); 4-5 squeeze and release; 6-8 5-4-3-2-1 grounding plus the math of 1% ($1.01^{365} \approx 37.8$; $0.99^{365} \approx 0.03$). Never display or cold call an individual check-in. Review support requests promptly and follow established support procedures.

Tuesday - Picture of the Day (care for our shared space): One illustrated classroom scene for every band: a finger pushes the first of 20 small dominoes (red, yellow, blue, green, repeated 5 times), which lead to a finale of 4 black dominoes that each grow 1.5 times taller, ending at a finish bell. The reveal plays the chain reaction; press Push again to replay. K-1: what will happen next? Count the red dominoes (5); find the bell. 2-3: notice and wonder; the pattern repeats 5 times, so $4 \times 5 = 20$. 4-5: explain the chain with first, next, finally (24 dominoes in all); a missing domino breaks the chain. 6-8: $2 \text{ in} \times 1.5^4 \approx 10.1 \text{ in}$; a falling domino can topple one about 1.5 times its size, so the 10th domino in that chain would be about 77 in. Close by connecting the chain to the room: one small move, such as a pushed-in chair, helps the next person.

Wednesday - Zoom In (try again: revise your guess): The Do Now magnifier shows a true close-up crop of the same picture the reveal uses. The reveal opens on that exact crop, holds for a moment, then slowly zooms out for about 12 seconds; the answer panel appears only after the zoom finishes. Press Zoom again to replay. Ask students whether their guess changed during the zoom. K-1: beads on threads become a dewy spider web; circle necklace, bubbles, spider web, or draw an idea. 2-3: dew drops and 12 spokes on a garden spider web; spiders build one thread at a time. 4-5: square tiles become a monarch mosaic; $60 \times 40 = 2,400$ tiles (rows $\times$ columns); monarchs migrate up to 3,000 miles in the fall. 6-8: dots of pure color become a pointillist sunset of 7,238 dots; optical mixing; Seurat painted A Sunday on La Grande Jatte (1884-86), about 7×10 feet, at the Art Institute of Chicago.

Thursday - Would You Rather (finish strong): Each band votes on its own choice with the +1 buttons; there is no single correct vote. Invite a reason and a fair retelling of another choice. K-1: the turtle or the rabbit; in the story, small steady steps finish first. 2-3: first runner or anchor on a relay team; a smooth handoff is a small move that can win the race. 4-5: 20 minutes every day or 2 hours on Saturday; $20 \times 7 = 140$ minutes vs. 120, and spaced practice helps memory. 6-8: \$1,000,000 today or a penny that doubles for 30 days; day 10 \$5.12, day 20 \$5,242.88, day 28 \$1,342,177.28, day 30 \$5,368,709.12. Then argue the other side.

Daily Ember: Every Ember video is new this week and chosen for its band and for that day's reflection. Monday names a small action; Tuesday its effect on a shared space or person; Wednesday a retry, help, or revision; Thursday a completed loose end or practice to carry forward. Accept a drawing, dictated response, or accommodated response. No public disclosures are required.

This week's Ember videos

New this week for every band and day. Each cell links the video, names the reflection, and opens that band's board on that day. Preview each video on the classroom computer before 2:05; if YouTube is blocked, the board switches to the offline breathing circle.

[Open K-1 board](#)[Open 2-3 board](#)[Open 4-5 board](#)[Open 6-8 board](#)

Day	K-1	2-3	4-5	6-8
Monday, Oct 5	<u>Monster Meditation: Focus Rhyme with Grover</u>	<u>Bring It Down</u> GoNoodle Flow	<u>Just Breathe</u> Wavecrest Films	<u>Circle of Control</u> Mental Health Center Kids

Day	K-1	2-3	4-5	6-8
	Sesame Street + Headspace Reflect: What small thing did you try today? <u>Open Monday board</u>	Reflect: Which small move helped you learn today? <u>Open Monday board</u>	Reflect: Which small action helped you start or restart today? <u>Open Monday board</u>	Reflect: Which action within your control improved your day? Name the moment and the effect. <u>Open Monday board</u>
Tuesday, Oct 6	<u>Rainbow Breath</u> GoNoodle Flow Reflect: How did you help our room today? <u>Open Tuesday board</u>	<u>Dealing with Difference</u> Cosmic Kids Zen Den Reflect: How did your choice help someone or our room? <u>Open Tuesday board</u>	<u>Why Are Some People Mean?</u> Cosmic Kids Zen Den Reflect: What effect did your choice have on our shared space? <u>Open Tuesday board</u>	<u>De-stress in 5 Minutes</u> Headspace Reflect: How did a choice you made affect someone else's learning or our space? <u>Open Tuesday board</u>
Wednesday, Oct 7	<u>Don't Give Up, with Bruno Mars</u> Sesame Street Reflect: What did you try again today? <u>Open Wednesday board</u>	<u>The Power of Yet, with Janelle Monáe</u> Sesame Street Reflect: When did you try again or ask for help? <u>Open Wednesday board</u>	<u>Perseverance 1: Katie Discovers the Dip</u> ClassDojo Reflect: How did feedback or help change your next attempt? <u>Open Wednesday board</u>	<u>How to Practice Effectively, for Just About Anything</u> TED-Ed Reflect: Where did new information lead you to revise, restart, or ask for help? <u>Open Wednesday board</u>
Thursday, Oct 8	<u>Monster Meditation: I-Sense with Cookie Monster</u> Sesame Street + Headspace Reflect: What are you proud of this week? <u>Open Thursday board</u>	<u>Candle of Concentration</u> Cosmic Kids Zen Den Reflect: What will you finish or put in its place before you leave? <u>Open Thursday board</u>	<u>Victorious</u> GoNoodle Flow Reflect: What will you close out today, and what useful habit will you keep? <u>Open Thursday board</u>	<u>Feeling Overwhelmed? Try This Quick Meditation</u> Headspace Reflect: Name one loose end you will close and one practice you will carry into next quarter. <u>Open Thursday board</u>

Prepare, coach, and verify

Prepare: open the grade-band Spark deck in Chrome; test English/Spanish read aloud and full screen. Keys 1-4 select a day; arrows move Do Now -> Reveal -> Handoff. Repeat aloud runs the entry prompt for staggered arrivals. Whole-week view lets teachers preview every slide.

Print: Spark pages are two sheets per band: four Monday check-in slips to cut apart, then one response page with Tuesday, Wednesday, and Thursday panels. Ember sheets include two matching slips per day. Set a fixed paper/pencil location and a private check-in collection spot. Review slips before students leave whenever follow-up is needed.

Clarity: give the same short entry cue: "Do Now first, then read/IXL." Access: let students draw, point, dictate, use the sentence frame, or use an appropriate lower-demand band. Regulation: offer a brief settling option and return to the task. Honor existing IEP/504 supports.

Expectation practice uses See-It / Name-It / Do-It: show the entry or seated dismissal move; name the observable action; rehearse it with a brief reset. Recognition names sustained evidence of Safe, Respectful, or Responsible using the established LiveSchool categories.

IXL: the dated package uses Week 6 from the existing August 31 start-date rule. Codes are embedded from the current source snapshot and refreshed from the existing IXL data URL. Source-missing codes display a dash; use the grade-specific IXL link to resolve them, never invent a replacement.

Weekly Videos and Do Now - First 5 Relax/Excite links remain visible on the package hub alongside the band decks and printables. Ember uses new age-band videos matched to each day's reflection and keeps the offline breathing fallback.

Sources: live Morning Meeting Playbook, existing Morning Spark guide/decks, existing Ember boards, and Matchbook Learning IXL data. This package supplies fresh weekly prompts; it preserves the established arrival and dismissal system.